Tenure-Track Faculty Appointment Start-Up Guide

Introduction

This manual provides standardized guidance for coordinating key activities that support new tenure-track faculty appointments at Eastport University. It aligns responsibilities across academic units, central administration, and shared services to ensure consistent execution. The guidance is intended for department administrators, college HR partners, and operational stakeholders who enable a faculty member's successful start. Adherence supports timely readiness for teaching, research, and service responsibilities.

Appointment Start-Up and Orientation Steps

After the department initiates the Background Check Authorization (BGC-2) in EastportWorks—or formally records that a check is not required—HR coordinates the faculty member's appointment start-up by confirming that an onboarding portal invitation has been issued (or that the system-generated invite has triggered correctly). The HR onboarding specialist tracks the portal dashboard for completion status and follows up promptly when required forms remain pending. Before the start date is finalized in payroll, the hire must submit tax withholding documentation (W-4 or equivalent), direct deposit banking information, and the New Hire Data Sheet (NHD-4) to capture a current home address and emergency contact details. Submissions are reviewed for completeness and basic accuracy, including full address elements and valid routing and account numbers, to prevent pay delays and compliance issues. When omissions or obvious errors are identified, corrections are requested through the portal's messaging function or documented via case notes to maintain an auditable record. Completing these identity and payroll items early supports timely system provisioning, first-pay accuracy, and a smoother transition into orientation activities across the college and central units.

Conclusion

Consistent execution of these guidelines improves the faculty experience and reduces operational delays at the start of an appointment. Clear role ownership and documented handoffs strengthen coordination across colleges and central offices. Following the prescribed standards helps ensure compliance, accurate records, and appropriate access provisioning. Regular review and disciplined use of these practices support Eastport University's growth in research-track hiring.